Photograph by **CHANDRADEEP KUMAR**



50.6 MICROGRAMS
Average PM2.5* concentration in India in 2024, 10 times the WHO's recommended limit

$10.5 BILLION
India's air pollution control systems market in 2024; expected to reach $18.2 billion by 2030

**fine particulate pollutants, likely to penetrate deep into the lungs*

compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 9.4 per cent. But doctors and health experts remain sceptical about many of these solutions, suggesting a holistic and long-term approach instead. "As air pollution continues to rise, people are looking for ways to protect themselves from its harmful effects. It is claimed that the new technologies can revive the air and minimise pollution's toll on health. But can they really bring back what long-term exposure to pollution destroys?" asks Dr Ravi Dosi, consultant, pulmonary medicine, Kokilaben Dhirubhai Ambani Hospital, Indore.

THE LATEST FADS

The sheer variety of anti-pollution products and therapies available is staggering. Solutions range from canned air sourced from the Swiss Alps, Italy's Lake Como, or the upper Himalayas closer home to anti-pollution paints and wearable air purifiers (see *Quick Fixes*). Air purifiers now come in various forms, including watches, keychains and necklaces. Lightweight and portable, these purifiers employ a range of technologies, from ionisation devices that use electrical charges to capture pollutants to components that mimic anti-smog guns, releasing fine nebulised water droplets that bind with airborne dust and particles, pulling them to the ground. "Air purifiers may work in some situations, especially where there